Project and Requirements Management
HR Employee Portal Development

2025

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INTRODUCTION

This report presents the planning and development of an internal HR Employee Portal as part of a course project in project and requirements management. The project addresses the need to improve internal HR processes such as leave management, employee communication, and access to HR documents. The proposed solution is a centralized digital platform designed to enhance efficiency, accessibility, and data accuracy across the organization.

The report is structured according to five key project phases. Section 1 outlines the business need and defines high-level business requirements. Section 2 covers the project initiation, including the business case and project charter. Section 3 details the stakeholder analysis, scope definition, and both functional and non-functional requirements, along with acceptance criteria. Section 4 presents the project plan, including a schedule, cost estimation, quality and risk plans, and team roles. Section 5 describes how requirements will be validated and monitored and outlines the traceability strategy.

The final sections of the report include a conclusion summarizing key achievements, challenges encountered, and lessons learned throughout the project. References and appendices provide supporting materials such as project charter documents, Gantt chart with dates and estimated hours, and weekly progress report template.

1. PRODUCT INCEPTION & BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS

1.1. Product overview

The project focuses on creating an internal HR Employee Portal. The goal is to unify and digitize essential HR operations across the organization such as managing leave requests, sharing policy updates, and handling HR documents that are carried out manually or through disconnected systems like emails and spreadsheets. These outdated methods lead to inefficiencies, slow communication, and challenges in keeping accurate and consistent records. The new portal will act as a centralized solution, providing secure, role-based access for both employees and HR personnel. Key features of the system will comprise a module for submitting and approving leave, a board for posting internal announcements, a centralized repository for HR documents, a searchable directory of employees, and an integrated real-time messaging feature. These features are designed to streamline workflows, improve communication, and enhance access to information.

The portal is intended for internal desktop/browser-based use and is scheduled for full deployment within a 15-week project timeline, with post-launch adoption and support by the HR and IT departments.

1.2. Business requirements

The following high-level business requirements were identified through stakeholder interviews and workshops:

Table 1 "*Business requirements"*

ID	Requirement	Priority	Rationale
BR1	The portal must support secure, role-based login for employees and HR staff.	High	Ensures data protection and limits unauthorized access.
BR2	The system must allow employees to submit, view, and track leave requests.	High	Replaces manual processing and improves transparency.
BR3	HR staff must be able to publish and manage internal announcements.	Medium	Keeps employees informed on policies and updates.
BR4	The portal must include a searchable directory with employee roles and contacts.	Medium	Encourages collaboration and speeds up internal communication.

BR5	The portal must provide access to downloadable HR forms and policy documents.	High	Reduces repetitive email queries and centralizes access to vital information.

These requirements reflect the core needs of both HR staff and general employees, ensuring the solution supports organizational goals and improves the employee experience.

2. PROJECT INITIATION

2.1. Business case

The organization currently relies on outdated, manual HR procedures and unconnected tools, which create inefficiencies, delays, and inconsistent employee communication. The business case for this project is centered around the need to modernize internal HR operations through a centralized digital solution.

By developing an HR Employee Portal, the organization aims to:

- Reduce administrative burden by automating key HR processes such as leave management and document handling.
- Enhance employee experience by providing easy, secure access to HR services and resources.
- Ensure compliance with internal policies and data protection regulations like GDPR.
- Increase operational efficiency through better communication and streamlined workflows.

This investment is justified by its potential to improve internal service delivery, strengthen HR-policy alignment, and boost overall employee satisfaction and productivity. The project will be completed within a fixed 15-week timeframe and operate within a budget of €30,000, with measurable outcomes including at least 90% employee adoption within two weeks of launch and 80% automation of HR requests in the first month of use.

2.2. Project charter

The HR Employee Portal Development project is formally initiated with a project charter approved by the Executive Sponsor and HR Department. It outlines key responsibilities, goals, and constraints (Appendix A - Project charter).

Project name: HR Employee Portal Development
Executive sponsor: Sanita Šulca, Chief Operating Officer
Department sponsor: Richard Black, HR Director
Project manager: Anna Kalnina, IT Department

Objectives:

- Deliver a fully functional HR portal within 15 weeks.
- Ensure secure, role-based access for employees and HR.
- Enable at least 80% of routine HR tasks (e.g., leave requests) to be processed online.

Key deliverables:

- Secure login system
- Leave request and approval module
- Internal announcement feature
- HR document repository
- Searchable employee directory
- Real-time messaging system

Constraints:

- Fixed budget: €30,000
- Limited IT resources (1 developer, part-time support)
- Web-only access (no mobile version)
- English-language interface only
- Compliance with GDPR and internal data policies

Key milestones:

Table 2 "*Key milestones"*

Phase	Start Date	End Date	Milestone Description
Inception	13.05.2025	25.05.2025	Project kickoff, stakeholder alignment, initial requirements gathered
Planning	25.05.2025	07.06.2025	Finalize scope, schedule, and resource planning
Design Phase	07.06.2025	12.06.2025	UI/UX design, wireframes, feedback from HR and executive sponsor
Development Phase 1	12.06.2025	19.06.2025	Core module development: login, leave system, announcements
Development Phase 2	19.06.2025	25.07.2025	Employee directory, document center, admin panel features
System Testing	25.07.2025	02.08.2025	Internal QA, bug fixes, data privacy/security testing
User Acceptance Testing (UAT)	02.08.2025	10.08.2025	Test by employees and HR team, gather final feedback
Deployment & Training	10.08.2025	22.08.2025	Portal go-live, employee training sessions, admin handover

Project Closeout	22.08.2025	05.09.2025	Final documentation, lessons learned, project review

The charter ensures alignment between strategic goals, department needs, and project execution, and serves as the formal approval for project commencement.

3. PRODUCT SCOPE & REQUIREMENTS

3.1. Stakeholders list and analysis

A detailed stakeholder analysis was conducted to identify all parties who influence or are affected by the HR Employee Portal. Their roles, interests, and expected impact are summarized in Table 3.

Table 3 *"Stakeholders list and analysis"*

Stakeholder	Role	Key Interests/Concerns	Expected Impact
Sanita Šulca	Executive Sponsor (COO)	Alignment with strategic goals, budget control, successful project delivery	High – Provides funding and strategic oversight
Richard Black	Department Sponsor (HR Director)	Usability for HR staff, improved efficiency, HR policy compliance	High – Oversees HR function and final approvals
Anna Kalnina	Project Manager	On-time delivery, task coordination, meeting scope and quality expectations	High – Responsible for execution and reporting
HR Team	Contributors and Users	Intuitive features, easy content updates, reduced manual effort	High – Daily users and process validators
All Employees	End Users	Simple access to HR tools and documents, data privacy, fast leave processing	High – Main beneficiaries of the portal
IT Department	Developers & Technical Support	Feasibility of implementation, security, and system stability	Medium – Responsible for backend functionality
Legal/Compliance Team	Policy & Risk Oversight	Ensuring GDPR compliance, secure handling of employee data	Medium – Ensures legal and ethical alignment

3.2. Functional & non-functional requirements

3.2.1. Functional requirements

Table 4 *"Functional requirements"*

FR ID	Description
FR1	The system shall allow employees to submit leave requests by selecting type, dates, and adding optional notes.
FR2	The portal shall allow HR staff to view, approve/reject, and comment on leave requests.
FR3	HR staff shall be able to upload and organize HR documents (PDFs, policies) into categorized folders.
FR4	Users shall receive real-time notifications for announcements, approvals, and system alerts.
FR5	The system shall include a search-enabled employee directory filterable by name, department, or title.

3.2.2. Non-functional requirements

Table 5 *"Non-functional requirements"*

NFR ID	Description
NFR1	The portal shall be accessible from all modern web browsers and optimized for screen sizes down to 1024px.
NFR2	System response time shall not exceed 3 seconds for login and directory searches.
NFR3	All data transmission shall be encrypted using HTTPS and meet GDPR compliance standards.
NFR4	The interface shall follow WCAG accessibility guidelines to ensure usability for all employees.
NFR5	Availability of the system should be maintained at 99% uptime during business hours.

3.3. Refined SMART requirements

Table 6 *"SMART requirements"*

ID	SMART Requirement
BR1	By the end of Week 8, the portal must allow all employees and HR staff to securely log in using role-based credentials with a login success rate of at least 98%.
BR2	By Week 10, the system must allow employees to submit, view, and track leave requests, with notifications sent to both HR and the employee within 2 minutes of submission.
BR3	HR staff must be able to create, edit, and publish internal announcements within the portal by Week 11, with posts appearing on the employee dashboard sorted by most recent.
BR4	By project completion, the portal must include a searchable employee directory where users can search by name, department, or job title, returning results in under 2 seconds.
BR5	By Week 9, the portal must provide access to at least 10 core HR documents in PDF format, all downloadable and opening successfully in major browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Edge).

3.3.1. Expanded requirements

Expanded Functional Requirement from BR2 – Leave Request System

- **FR2.1**: The system shall allow employees to select leave type (e.g., vacation, sick, unpaid), specify start/end dates, and submit the request.
- **FR2.2**: Upon submission, the system shall notify HR via email and show a pending status in the employee's portal view.
- **FR2.3**: HR shall be able to approve/reject requests, triggering an automatic notification and status update.

Expanded Non-Functional Requirement from BR1 – Login System

- **NFR1.1**: The portal must authenticate users within 3 seconds on average under normal load conditions.
- **NFR1.2**: The system shall enforce password complexity rules (min. 8 characters, uppercase, number, special character).
- **NFR1.3**: Login attempts must be logged and locked after 5 failed tries to comply with security standards.

3.4. Scope definition

3.4.1. In-Scope Features:

Secure Login System – Role-based access for employees and HR staff.

Leave Request and Approval Module – Allows employees to submit and monitor leave requests.

Internal Announcement Board – HR can post updates, policies, and organizational news.

HR Document Repository – Centralized access to policies, templates, and forms.

Searchable Employee Directory – View and search employee roles, departments, and contact info.

Real-Time Messaging Tool – Enables employees to communicate directly within the portal for HR-related queries or internal collaboration.

3.4.2. Out-of-Scope:

The following items are not within the scope of this project phase:

Mobile application development – Access is limited to desktop and browser-based platforms.

Integration with third-party payroll or biometric attendance systems – These will continue to operate independently.

Multi-language support – The portal will be developed in English only.

Advanced HR analytics or self-service benefits enrolment features – Not part of the current functionality set.

3.5. Acceptance Criteria

Each of the project deliverables will be considered successfully completed when the following criteria are met:

Login System - Employees and HR personnel can securely access the portal using role-based credentials. The system demonstrates a minimum 98% successful login rate during testing.

Leave Request Module- Employees can submit leave requests through the portal, and HR can approve or reject them. Each request must trigger a notification and be trackable by both the employee and HR.

Internal Announcement Board - HR staff can create, edit, and publish announcements. All announcements are displayed to employees upon login and are sorted by date with the most recent visible at the top.

HR Document Repository - A minimum of ten key HR documents (such as policies, forms, and templates) must be uploaded and accessible. All documents should be downloadable in PDF format and open without errors in major web browsers.

Employee Directory - The directory must include accurate and up-to-date employee names, job titles, departments, and contact information. Users must be able to search by name, department, or title.

Real-Time Messaging Tool - Employees must be able to send and receive messages within the portal. Messages should be delivered instantly, stored securely, and accessible only by authorized users. The messaging tool must function reliably under standard usage conditions.

4. PROJECT PLANNING

4.1.Project schedule

The HR Employee Portal is scheduled to be delivered over a 15-week development timeline, with clearly defined phases including planning, design, development, testing, and deployment. The schedule supports iterative feedback and quality control across the life cycle.

(A full Gantt chart is provided in Appendix B.)

Table 7 *"Project schedule"*

Phase	**Start Date**	**End Date**	**Milestone Description**
Inception	13.05.2025	25.05.2025	Define goals, set up team, conduct studies, kickoff meeting with stakeholders, develop project charter
Planning	25.05.2025	07.06.2025	Develop project charter, create project schedule, develop budge, confirm technical roadmap, identify risks and mitigation actions
Design Phase	07.06.2025	12.06.2025	Design portal structure and wireframes, review design, finalize UI/UX adjustments
Development Phase 1	12.06.2025	19.06.2025	Develop secure login system, develop leave request & approval module, develop internal announcement board
Development Phase 2	19.06.2025	25.07.2025	Progress monitoring and task coordination, develop employee directory, develop HR document repository, develop admin panel features
System Testing	25.07.2025	02.08.2025	Internal QA and bug fixes, HR functional testing, data privacy & security testing,
User Acceptance Testing (UAT)	02.08.2025	10.08.2025	Coordinate UAT sessions with employees, collect and document feedback, analyze UAT results
Deployment & Training	10.08.2025	22.08.2025	Go-live coordination, conduct employee training sessions, admin handover and documentation
Project Closeout	22.08.2025	05.09.2025	Collect lessons learned, track expenses, evaluate progress, address risks, finalize

			project documentation, present final project review

4.2. Cost estimation

Two estimation techniques were applied: analogous and bottom-up. The bottom-up method produced a detailed and transparent cost structure based on the team's hourly rates and task allocation.

4.2.1. Analogous estimation

Reviewing a comparable HR Portal project completed for another mid-sized organization in 2024, the overall cost amounted to 28 000 EUR. Given that this project involves extra features such as a real-time messaging system and is designed for a larger number of users, the estimated cost is reasonably increased to 30 000 EUR, which matches the set project budget.

Table 8 *"Analogous estimation"*

Reference Project Cost	28 000 EUR
Additional Functionalities (Messaging, Scaling)	2 000 EUR
Total Analogous Estimate	30 00 EUR

4.2.2. Bottom-Up estimation

The project cost was determined based on the task breakdown and the hourly rates specific to each team, as outlined below:

Table 9 *"Bottom-Up estimation"*

Responsible Person	**Total Hours**	**Hourly Rate (EUR)**	**Cost (EUR)**
Alens Ozols (Developer)	386	33	12 738
Dinija Bega (Designer)	30	30	900
Anna Kalnina (Project Manager)	254	23	5 842
Vita Rudzite (HR Specialist)	205	20	4 100
Total	**875**		**23 580**

This estimate includes a 6 420 EUR contingency reserve, intended to cover unexpected costs or potential enhancements to quality.

4.2.3. Preferred method

Analogous Estimation provides a quick reference against past budgets, but Bottom-Up Estimation delivers greater accuracy, clarity, and justification by detailing costs by resource and task. It also reveals a realistic budget surplus, supporting better risk management. Therefore, Bottom-Up Estimation is the preferred approach.

4.3. Quality & risk plans

4.3.1. Quality standards for key deliverables

Table 10 *"Quality standards for key deliverables"*

Deliverable	**Quality Standard**
Secure Login System	98% successful login rate during testing, role-based access without security gaps.
Leave Request & Approval Module	100% notification delivery on leave status updates; accessible within 3 clicks.
Internal Announcement Board	Posts visible on login, sorted by date, no display errors across browsers.
HR Document Repository	Minimum 10 documents accessible and downloadable in PDF format without file issues.
Employee Directory	Accurate search results within 2 seconds for name, title, or department queries.
Real-Time Messaging Tool	Message delivery latency under 1 second; messages secured per privacy standards.

4.3.2. Quality control measures

Testing protocols:

- Unit Testing for individual modules (Login, Leave System, etc.).
- Integration Testing to verify data flow between modules.
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) with HR team and selected employees to validate functionality.

Regular reviews and validation:

- Weekly Review Meetings with the Project Team to assess deliverable quality.
- Stakeholder Review Sessions at key milestones (Design, Development, UAT).

4.3.3. Risk analysis matrix

Table 11 "Risk analysis matrix"

Risk	**Impact (High/Medium/Low)**	**Likelihood (High/Medium/Low)**	**Mitigation Strategy**
Integration Complexity	High	Medium	Plan early integration testing; involve IT specialists early.
Data Privacy Compliance Failure	High	High	Consult legal/compliance team throughout development.
User Adoption Resistance	Medium	High	Schedule training and provide user-friendly documentation.

4.4. Team roles and stakeholder communication

4.4.1. Team roles and responsibilities

Table 12 *"Team roles and responsibilities"*

Team Member	**Role**	**Responsibilities**
Anna Kalnina	Project Manager	Overall project planning, task coordination, timeline tracking, stakeholder reporting.
Alens Ozols	IT Developer	Development of system functionalities: login, leave management, directory, and messaging features.
Dinija Bega	UI/UX Designer	Design of user-friendly portal interface, wireframes, and usability improvements.
Vita Rudzite	HR Representative	Providing HR requirements, validating features, and ensuring alignment with HR policies.

Richard Black	HR Director (Sponsor)	Approving final deliverables, providing strategic HR direction.
Sanita Šulca	Executive Sponsor	Overseeing project alignment with organizational goals, approving budget and scope.

4.4.2. Onboarding and resource reassignment procedures

Onboarding new members:

- Introduce the new member during the weekly team meeting.
- Provide project background, timeline, and access to project documentation.
- Assign a team mentor for onboarding support.

Reassigning resources:

- Evaluate the impact on project timeline and workload.
- Obtain approval from the Executive Sponsor.
- Update project documentation and inform the team.
- Ensure proper knowledge transfer to the new assignee.

4.4.3. Communication plan

Table 13 *"Primary communication methods"*

Communication Method	**Purpose**	**Frequency**
Weekly Team Meetings	Review progress, address blockers, assign next tasks.	Weekly
Bi-Weekly Sponsor Reports	Provide status updates to executive and HR sponsors.	Bi-Weekly
Email Updates	Share important updates, approvals, and announcements.	As needed
Shared Project Folder (Drive)	Store documentation, schedules, and reports.	Continuous
Ad Hoc Meetings	Urgent discussions or decisions.	As needed

4.4.4. Stakeholder communication matrix

Table 14 *"Stakeholder communication matrix"*

Stakeholder	**Information Needs**	**Frequency**	**Communication Method**
Project Team	Task assignments, progress	Weekly	Team Meetings, Shared Folder
Executive Sponsor	Milestone progress, risks	Bi-Weekly	Sponsor Report, Email
HR Director	Functional validation updates	Bi-Weekly	Sponsor Report, Email
IT Team	Technical issues, dependencies	Weekly	Team Meetings
All Employees	Portal launch updates	Key Milestones	Company-Wide Announcement
Legal/Compliance	Privacy and compliance status	As Needed	Email, Review Meetings

5. REQUIREMENTS & MONITORING STRATEGIES

5.1. Requirements traceability & validation

To ensure each requirement supports a specific stakeholder need or project objective, a traceability matrix was created. It shows how functional requirements directly connect to business drivers and end-user expectations.

Table 15 *"Traceability matrix"*

Requirement ID	Linked Stakeholder(s)	Linked Project Goal
BR1	IT Department, All Employees	Ensure secure, role-based access with minimal downtime
BR2	HR Team, All Employees	Automate and track HR processes to reduce manual intervention
BR3	HR Director, All Employees	Improve internal communication and reduce email reliance
BR4	All Employees	Facilitate collaboration and easy access to employee contact information
BR5	HR Team, Legal/Compliance	Centralize HR documentation and meet compliance with digital access laws

Table 16 "Stakeholder Validation Summary"

Requirement	Validated By	Feedback	Changes Made
BR1	IT Department	Needed to specify performance metrics	Added login success rate and response time
BR2	HR Team	Requested email notifications and tracking statuses	Added functional details for status and notifications
BR3	HR Director	Wanted sorting by recency and ability to edit posts	Included announcement sorting and editing capabilities
BR4	All Employees (Feedback Group)	Wanted fast, filtered search by role and department	Clarified filters and performance expectations
BR5	HR Team & Compliance	Wanted browser compatibility and format standards	Specified PDF format and browser compatibility

Validation Activities:

- Interviews with HR Director, HR staff, and employees gathered key user expectations and frustrations.
- Workshops with IT and design teams helped assess technical feasibility and usability.
- Feedback was integrated into SMART criteria and functional requirements (see Section 3).
- UAT (planned) to confirm final implementation matches expectations and meets performance criteria.

Each requirement was revised based on stakeholder input — for example, BR2 was expanded to include status notifications, and BR1 now includes login success rate and response time thresholds.

5.2. Monitoring/control strategy

To ensure timely delivery, compliance, and stakeholder satisfaction, a structured monitoring and control strategy will be applied:

Monitoring Methods

- **Gantt Chart**: Used to visualize progress across milestones (*see Appendix B – "Gantt Chart"*).
- **Weekly Check-ins**: The project team meets every week to assess task status, identify blockers, and adjust assignments.
- **Bi-weekly Status Reports**: Submitted to sponsors with updates on schedule, risk, and upcoming goals *(see Appendix C - "Weekly Progress Report").*

Performance Metrics:

- % of tasks completed on time
- Feature delivery vs. scope baseline
- Stakeholder feedback during UAT
- Budget tracking against forecast

Issue & Change Management:

- Issues are logged and reviewed during weekly meetings.
- A **Change Request Process** is in place:

a) Stakeholder submits a formal request.
b) Project Manager evaluates feasibility and impact.
c) Sponsor approves or rejects.
d) Scope and documentation are updated if approved.

Risk Monitoring

Risk management will be a continuous process throughout the project lifecycle. A risk register will be maintained and updated weekly by the Project Manager. The team will review risks during regular status meetings to assess their status, likelihood, and potential impact.

Key monitoring activities include:

- **Weekly Risk Review**: All open risks will be revisited during the team's weekly meeting. New risks will be added to the log with assigned owners.
- **Traffic Light System**: Risks will be categorized as *Green* (under control), *Amber* (monitor closely), or *Red* (requires immediate action).
- **Trigger Events**: Certain conditions (e.g., delays in development or test failures) will act as predefined triggers to escalate risks.
- **Risk Log Updates**: Any mitigation actions taken will be recorded, and risk status will be updated (e.g., active, resolved, escalated).
- **Reporting**: High-priority risks will be included in bi-weekly sponsor reports with recommendations and decisions.

After project completion, a post-project review will evaluate which risks materialized and how effective the mitigation strategies were, contributing to future project risk knowledge.

CONCLUSION

The HR Employee Portal project successfully addressed the organization's need for a centralized, digital platform to streamline core HR processes. Key achievements include the definition of clear business and functional requirements, development of a realistic 15-week implementation plan, and thorough stakeholder analysis with validated user expectations. Detailed cost estimation, risk management strategies, and traceability tools were also created to support effective delivery.

Throughout the project, several challenges and omissions were encountered. One issue was the initial lack of detail in non-functional requirements, which was resolved through feedback during validation workshops. Additionally, there were difficulties estimating costs early on due to limited historical data; this was addressed by applying both analogous and bottom-up estimation methods. Time management was occasionally pressured by the need to balance documentation requirements across multiple assignment phases. A further limitation was the exclusion of mobile compatibility and third-party integration due to time and budget constraints.

From this experience, several lessons were learned. First, engaging stakeholders early and consistently is essential for refining realistic, useful requirements. Second, traceability and monitoring tools (such as matrices and Gantt charts) greatly enhance visibility and control across the project lifecycle. Finally, allocating time specifically for documentation and iterative review is crucial for ensuring quality and meeting academic expectations.

Overall, the project demonstrates the importance of structured planning, stakeholder communication, and adaptability when managing a real-world digital solution.

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APPENDICES

Appendix A – "Project Charter"

PROJECT CHARTER

1. General Project Information	
Project Name:	**HR Employee Portal Development**
Executive Sponsors:	**Chief Operating Officer – Sanita Šulca**
Department Sponsor:	**HR Director – Richard Black**
Impact of project:	**This portal will centralize HR functions, reduce manual paperwork, increase efficiency, and improve employee experience. It will also support compliance with internal policies and data privacy regulations.**

2. Project Team	Name	Department	Telephone	E-mail
Project Manager:	Anna Kalnina	IT	3712675688	Anna.kalnina@hrcompany.com
Team Members:	Vita Rudzite	HR	3712626842	Vita.rudzite@hrcompany.com
	Alens Ozols	IT	3714586546	Alens.ozols@hrcompany.com
	Dinija Bega	Design	3711856824	Dinija.berga@hrcompany.com

3. Stakeholders
Executive Sponsor - Sanita Šulca, Chief Operating Officer
Department Sponsor – Richard Black, HR Director
HR Team Members - Primary users and contributors of HR data
All Employees – End users of the portal who will access HR services
IT Department – Responsible for portal development, integration, and maintenance
Legal/Compliance Team – Ensures data privacy and policy adherence

4. Project Scope Statement
Project Purpose / Business Justification
The organization currently manages HR tasks using manual methods and various disconnected tools, leading to inefficiencies, delays, and fragmented communication with employees. Implementing a centralized HR Employee Portal will unify and simplify key processes like leave management, internal updates, document access, and employee information. This solution will enhance clarity, boost productivity, and contribute to greater employee satisfaction.
Objectives (in business terms

Launch a fully functional HR portal within 15 weeks of project initiation.

Achieve at least 90% employee login adoption within two weeks of launch.

Automate 80% of HR-related requests (e.g., leave submissions) within the first month.

Deliverables

Secure employee login and authentication system

Leave request and approval module

Internal announcement board

HR document repository (e.g., policies, cv, agreements)

Searchable employee directory

Scope

Included:

Web-based HR portal for internal company use

Features: secure login, leave request workflow, internal announcements, document repository, and employee directory

Access for all current employees and HR personnel

Real-time chat or messaging tools

Not Included:

Mobile app development

Integration with third-party payroll or attendance systems

Multi-language support

Project Milestones

Phase	Start Date	End Date	Milestone Description
Inception	13.05.2025	25.05.2025	Project kickoff, stakeholder alignment, initial requirements gathered
Planning	25.05.2025	07.06.2025	Finalize scope, schedule, and resource planning
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Project Closeout	22.08.2025	05.09.2025	Final documentation, lessons learned, project review

Major Known Risks (including significant Assumptions)

Risk	Risk Rating (Hi, Med, Lo)
Integration challenges	Integrating the portal with current payroll or attendance systems may present unforeseen complexities. (Hi)
Data security concerns	Personal employee data must be protected. (Hi)
User resistance	Some team members might be hesitant to shift away from paper and email–based workflows. (Hi)

Constraints

The project has a maximum budget of EUR 30 000, which restricts the use of advanced tools or hiring external specialists.

Completion must occur within a strict 15-week period, as extensions are not feasible due to business needs.

The team includes only a single developer, designer, and project manager, which may limit the ability to handle multiple tasks simultaneously.

The portal must adhere to data privacy laws, which may narrow the range of technical solutions.

IT support is limited, with only part-time availability, potentially impacting testing and system rollout.

External Dependencies

Prompt availability of up-to-date employee information from HR is necessary to build the employee directory.

Collaboration with the IT team is needed to enable internal hosting and configure network access.

Guidance from the legal and compliance team is crucial to ensure the system meets data protection requirements.

Input from employee representatives during User Acceptance Testing (UAT) is required to validate functionality and usability.

5. Communication Strategy

Weekly project team meetings will be held to review progress, address blockers, and assign tasks.

Bi-weekly status reports will be sent to the Executive and Department Sponsors summarizing milestones, risks, and upcoming work.

Ad hoc meetings may be scheduled for urgent decisions or feedback sessions.

Email updates will be used for key announcements, deliverable submissions, and approvals.

All project documentation will be stored in a **shared project folder** accessible to stakeholders.

6. Sign-off

	Name	Signature	Date (DD.MM.YYYY)
Executive Sponsor	Sanita Šulca		07.05.2025
Department Sponsor	Richard Black		07.05.2025
Project Manager	Anna Kalnina		07.05.2025

7. Notes

Appendix B – “Gantt Chart”

HR Employee Portal Development

TASK	ASSIGNED TO	Estimated hours	PROGRESS	START	END
Inception					
Define goals	Anna Kalnina	8	100%	13.05.2025	15.05.2025
Set up team	Anna Kalnina	4	100%	15.05.2025	17.05.2025
Conduct studies	Vita Rudzite	24	100%	17.05.2025	20.05.2025
Kickoff meeting with stakeholders	Anna Kalnina	6	100%	21.05.2025	21.05.2025
Develop project charter	Anna Kalnina	12	100%	22.05.2025	25.05.2025
Planning					
Define scope and deliverables	Vita Rudzite	12	100%	25.05.2025	27.05.2025
Create project schedule	Anna Kalnina	20	100%	27.05.2025	29.05.2025
Develop budget	Anna Kalnina	20	100%	29.05.2025	31.05.2025
Confirm technical roadmap	Alens Ozols	6	90%	31.05.2025	03.06.2025
Identify risks and mitigation actions	Vita Rudzite	12	35%	03.06.2025	07.06.2025
Design					
Design portal structure and wireframes	Dinija Bega	18	0%	07.06.2025	10.06.2025
Review design	Vita Rudzite	8	0%	10.06.2025	10.06.2025
Finalize UI/UX adjustments	Dinija Bega	12	0%	10.06.2025	12.06.2025
Development					
Develop Secure Login system	Alens Ozols	16	0%	12.06.2025	13.06.2025
Develop Leave Request & Approval module	Alens Ozols	32	0%	13.06.2025	16.06.2025
Develop Internal Announcement Board	Alens Ozols	32	0%	16.06.2025	19.06.2025
Progress monitoring and task coordination	Anna Kalnina	12	0%	19.06.2025	22.06.2025
Develop Employee Directory	Alens Ozols	100	0%	22.06.2025	04.07.2025
Develop HR Document Repository	Alens Ozols	95	0%	04.07.2025	17.07.2025
Develop Admin Panel Features	Alens Ozols	65	0%	17.07.2025	25.07.2025
Testing					
Internal QA and Bug Fixes	Alens Ozols	40	0%	25.07.2025	29.07.2025
HR Functional Testing	Vita Rudzite	24	0%	29.07.2025	31.07.2025
Data Privacy & Security Testing	Anna Kalnina	20	0%	31.07.2025	02.08.2025
Coordinate UAT Sessions with Employees	Vita Rudzite	24	0%	02.08.2025	05.08.2025
Collect and Document Feedback	Vita Rudzite	24	0%	05.08.2025	07.08.2025
Analyze UAT Results	Anna Kalnina	24	0%	07.08.2025	10.08.2025
Deployment & Training					
Go-live Coordination	Anna Kalnina	40	0%	10.08.2025	14.08.2025
Conduct Employee Training Sessions	Vita Rudzite	40	0%	14.08.2025	18.08.2025
Admin Handover and Documentation	Anna Kalnina	24	0%	18.08.2025	22.08.2025
Project Closeout					
Collect Lessons Learned	Anna Kalnina	16	0%	22.08.2025	23.08.2025
Track expenses	Anna Kalnina	8	0%	12.06.2025	31.08.2025
Evaluate progress	Vita Rudzite	25	0%	22.06.2025	31.08.2025
Address risks	Vita Rudzite	12	0%	12.06.2025	31.08.2025
Finalize Project Documentation	Anna Kalnina	24	0%	31.08.2025	02.09.2025
Present Final Project Review	Anna Kalnina	16	0%	02.09.2025	05.09.2025
	Total hours	**875**			

Appendix C – "Weekly Progress Report"

Weekly Project Progress Report

Project Name: HR Employee Portal Development

Reporting Week Ending: [Date]

Prepared By: [Project Manager Name]

1. Key Progress Metrics

Metric	Planned Value	Current Status
Task Completion (%)		
Resource Hours Used		
Budget Spent (EUR)		
Open/Resolved Issues		
Milestone Progress		

2. Task Status Overview

Task/Deliverable	Status	Comments

3. Budget Tracking

Resource/Activity	Planned Cost (€)	Actual Cost (€)	Variance (€)
Development Team			
Design Team			
Project Management			
HR/Stakeholder Input			
Total			

4. Risks and Issues

Risk/Issue	Severity (High/Med/Low)	Action Taken/Planned
1. 2. 3.		